Year 11 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y11/Y11_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Year 11 joins the pack at version 3.1, so that every year group carries one version number: there is no earlier Year 11 paper. The core paper has the structure of Year 10 version 3.1, and two further booklets are given on the same day from their own documents: the **cognitive ability screen** (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12`, guide `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`) and the **optional sciences** (`Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1`, mark scheme `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`). Do not mix papers and instructions from different years or versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

- **Listening** (16 marks): Part A is an everyday conversation at a sports centre; **Part B** is an academic talk at the level of a lesson (bamboo as a building material).
- **Reading** (16 marks): Part A is a web page of holiday workshops; Part B is the short story "Homing" (questions 8 to 14).
- **Maths** (30 marks): three sections that are scored separately: **Fluency** (10), **Word questions** (8) and **Applied problems** (12), at the level of the end of the first IGCSE Extended year. A scientific calculator is allowed in Section C only.
- **Science** (10 marks): IGCSE first-year biology, chemistry and physics, with one working-scientifically question.
- **Cognitive ability screen** and **optional sciences**: separate booklets (see Section 1). Their results are recorded on this year's grading sheet.

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 11** (age 15 on 1 September), the **second year of a two-year IGCSE course**: they join courses that are already a year in. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 9 (初三)**, so all of junior high school and the zhongkao; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 10 (高一). Some come from international or bilingual schools that teach IGCSE, and may have done part of Year 10 already. Ask the student and the family which grade, which school system and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E); maths against the end of the first IGCSE Extended year, as three sub-scores (fluency, word questions, applied problems); core science at IGCSE first-year level; a reasoning profile (the cognitive screen); readiness for the sciences chosen (the optional sciences); and, through the interview, who the student is, their plans and their suitability. Section 6 explains how to read the results together to judge **readiness for joining the second year of IGCSE**.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		These instructions
2	Listening: Part A (questions 1 to 8) and Part B (questions 9 to 16), 16 marks	about 15 (the recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads both scripts (Section 3.1); a small group is fine	Student paper pages 2 to 5; pencil; the recording	Student paper; grading sheet
3	Reading paper: Parts A and B (16 marks)	15	Student works alone	Student paper pages 6 to 10	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student works alone	Student paper pages 11 to 12	
5	Break	5		Water	

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
6	Maths: Section A Fluency, Section B Word questions, Section C Applied problems (30 marks)	25	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 13 to 19; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator in Sections A and B**; a **scientific calculator for Section C only** (from page 17)	A scientific calculator for each student
7	Core science: 6 questions (10 marks)	8	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 20 to 22; a calculator is allowed	
8	Break	5		Water	
9	**Cognitive ability screen**: three reasoning parts (12 items each) and processing speed (90 seconds); strict timing	25	Assessor, from `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`; a small group is fine	`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12` booklet; pencil; a stopwatch; no calculator	The screen booklet; its guide (print once)
10	**Optional sciences**: Biology, Chemistry, Physics, 15 marks each; only those the student will take (a short break after two)	15 each	Assessor, from `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`	`Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1` booklet; pencil, ruler, scientific calculator	The optional sciences booklet; its mark scheme (print once)
11	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 9**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences	Reading front sheet; Interview sheet for Years 11 and 12
	Total: core about 2 hours; with two optional sciences about 2 hours 35 minutes; with three about 2 hours 50 minutes	**about 120** (allow 125)		A clock or timer	Final mark sheet

A long day. The core paper, the break and the cognitive screen take about two hours. **The optional sciences and the interview may be given on a second visit** if the day is too long for the student or the timetable: arrange it with the family when the assessment is booked, and record on the grading sheet which parts were done on which day.

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths, core science, the optional sciences, the cognitive screen and readiness), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 11 student paper, version 3.1;
- the grading sheet (`Y11/Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the cognitive ability screen booklet (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Y11_Y12`);
- the optional sciences booklet (`Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_v3.1`), if the student takes any science;
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 11 and 12 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- `shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide` and `Y11/Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a clock or timer, a stopwatch, a plain card to cover the sentences, and a scientific calculator, pencil, rubber and ruler for each student.

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) runs alongside with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 10) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is

always 1:1.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Keep a scientific calculator for each student on your desk until they reach maths Section C. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. Please write all your answers in English. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. You can use a calculator only in the last section of the maths and in the science, and I will give it to you then. After this paper there is a short reasoning test, and then the science papers for the subjects you are choosing. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Pace of speech. Year 11 students may still be learning English: speak steadily and clearly, with a short pause after each sentence, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way (the Years 7 to 10 pace: the voice's normal speed, with about half a second after each sentence).

Access rules (the same in every year group, with the calculator rule for this paper)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the number of L questions on the grading sheet: it is evidence about English.
Answers	**All answers in English.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**All answers in English**: numbers, symbols, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0 (this includes the "Reason", "Show" and "Explain" answers).
Calculator	Not used.	Maths Sections A and B: **no calculator**. Maths Section C and science: a **scientific calculator**. The cognitive screen: no calculator (its guide).
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics on the grading sheet.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet. The cognitive screen is strictly timed and has its own access rules (its guide): extra time is not given on the screen, but a known need is recorded beside its results.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** if the student scores 2 or fewer out of 8 in Part A (questions 1 to 8), you may leave out Part B: check Part A quickly in the minute after it. Say: "Thank you. That is the end of the listening." Record "Part B not given" on the grading sheet; the band then comes from Part A alone (band A). In a group, play Part B to everyone as usual; a student with 2 or fewer in Part A may sit quietly.
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it on the Reading front sheet. Do not move them on to Part B.

- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed. Give the calculator when the student turns to Section C (page 17); in a group, give each student theirs when they reach that page. If a student goes back to Section A or B after that, take the calculator back while they work on it.
- **Cognitive screen and optional sciences:** follow the stopping rules in their own guides. A student who is tired after the core paper may take the optional sciences on a second visit (Section 1).
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it on the grading sheet.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

3. English

3.1 Listening (16 marks: Part A 8, Part B 8)

There are two parts, and each is played or read twice. **Part A** is an everyday conversation between a student and a receptionist at a sports centre: two voices. **Part B** is a short lesson-style talk by an engineer, with subject vocabulary, numbers, a correction and an implied opinion: the listening that IGCSE lessons need, at the level of a fluent speaker of 15 to 16.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y11/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. If you read live, use the pace in Section 2 and, for Part A, change your voice slightly for the two speakers. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. In Part A, you will hear a conversation between a student, Li Na, and a receptionist at a sports centre. You will hear it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Play or read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Play or read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a talk by an engineer, Dr Lin Feng, about a building material. You will hear it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Play or read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Play or read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read both scripts twice at the steady pace in Section 2. At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat sentences or explain anything. Read Part B at the same pace as Part A: it is meant to sound like a lesson.

Timing. One reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes and of Part B about 3 minutes, with the pauses. With one minute to read each set of questions, the 10-second gaps between the two readings and one minute to finish each part, the listening takes about 15 minutes. **Allow about 15 minutes.**

Script, Part A: At the sports centre

Receptionist: Good afternoon. How can I help you?

Li Na: Hello. I'd like to join the swimming pool, please. I'm a student at Riverside School. [pause]

Receptionist: No problem. Do you just want to swim, or are you interested in the badminton courts and the running track as well? A full membership covers everything.

Li Na: Just the pool, thanks. I'm training for the school swimming team. [pause]

Receptionist: Then a pool membership is best. For students, it's one hundred and twenty yuan a month. Adults pay two hundred. You need to show me your student card today, and bring one passport photo for your membership card. We can take the photo here, but that costs twenty yuan. [pause]

Li Na: I've got my student card here. I'll bring a photo tomorrow. What are the opening times?

Receptionist: Monday to Friday, we open at six thirty in the morning and close at nine at night. At the weekend, we open at seven and close at eight. The pool is closed on Wednesday mornings for cleaning, until twelve o'clock. [pause]

Li Na: And how big is the pool?

Receptionist: It's twenty-five metres long, with eight lanes. In the evenings, after five o'clock, two lanes are kept for lessons, so there are only six for everyone else, and it gets very busy. If you want a quiet lane, come before school. [pause]

Li Na: Before school? Oh no. I'd better set an alarm. [pause]

Receptionist: One more thing. On Tuesday evenings, from seven until eight, there's a session with a coach. It's free for members. Most of the people who come are training for competitions. The coach watches how you swim and tells you what to change.

Li Na: That sounds perfect. Thank you very much. [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**A** (swimming)		B or C: the receptionist mentions badminton and the running track, but Li Na says "Just the pool".
2	**Wednesday mornings**		Monday (not said); Sunday evenings (the weekend closing time is 8, but the pool is not closed for cleaning then).
3	**B** (a photo)		A (the student card: she has it and shows it today); C (not said).
4	**120**	one hundred and twenty	200 (the adult price); 20 (the cost of a photo).
5	**6**	six	8 (the total number of lanes); 2 (the lanes kept for lessons).
6	**7:00**	7; seven; 7 am; seven o'clock	6:30 (Monday to Friday); 8 (closing time); 12 (the end of cleaning).
7	**Because she will have to get up (very) early to swim before school**	the quiet time is before school, so she must wake up early; she is not used to getting up early	"Because she wants to swim" with no idea of early; "because the pool is busy" (the cause, but not why an alarm).

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
8	**Because Li Na is training for the team, and the coach can help her swim better (improve her technique)**	it is for people training for competitions, like her; it is free for members and useful for her training	"Because it is on Tuesday"; "because it is free" alone (true, but not why it is relevant to her).

Script, Part B: a talk about bamboo

Good morning. My name is Dr Lin Feng, and I'm a structural engineer. That means I work out how to make buildings stand up. Today I want to talk about bamboo. [pause]

The first thing to understand is that bamboo is not a tree. It's a grass, a very large one. A tree adds a thin ring of wood each year, so a hardwood tree may take forty years or more to reach its full size. Bamboo, on the other hand, sends up a new shoot that reaches its full height in a single growing season of a few months. After that, the pole doesn't grow any taller; it simply hardens. The pole is called a culm, and it is hollow, divided into sections by solid walls called nodes. The nodes are what give the pole its strength: without them, it would fold like a drinking straw. [pause]

That hardening takes time. A culm can be cut after two years. Actually, let me correct that: two years is too young, because the fibres are still soft. For building, we wait at least four years. The poles are then treated, because insects love fresh bamboo. First, the cut poles are soaked in a salt solution for about a week, which drives the sugars out of the fibres. Second, they are dried slowly in the shade for two months; dried too fast in the sun, they crack. [pause]

How strong is bamboo? In our laboratory we measure tensile strength, which simply means how hard you can pull on a material before it breaks. Weight for weight, the treated bamboo we tested was about as strong in tension as mild steel, and far stronger than the pine used in most timber frames. However, a bamboo pole is weak where you join it to another pole, because a bolt through a hollow tube cracks the wall. As a result, most of the engineering in a bamboo building is in the joints, not in the poles. [pause]

In 2022, my team designed a sports hall for a school in Guangxi, using bamboo for the whole roof. The frame cost about a third less than a steel frame would have cost, and it was built by local workers in eleven weeks. Growing the bamboo took carbon dioxide out of the air, whereas making a tonne of steel releases nearly two tonnes of it. [pause]

I should be honest about the drawbacks. Bamboo rots if it stays wet, so the roof must keep it dry. Poles are not all the same size, so every joint has to be measured by hand. And some architects still call bamboo "the poor man's timber". I notice that the same architects are quite happy to be photographed in front of our hall. [pause]

Your school is planning a new bicycle shelter. I'm not going to tell you what it should be made of. But I'd like you to ask the question. Thank you. [pause]

Part B answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the word is recognisable and the meaning is clear. Every answer is said in the script, and the questions follow the order of the script.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number), after a correction	**4** (years)	four; at least four; 4 or more	**2**: the number he corrects ("Actually, let me correct that"). An answer of 2 shows the student caught the first number but not the correction. 40 (the tree) shows the comparison was not followed.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
10	Note completion (a process)	**salt solution**	salt water; a solution of salt; salty water; recognisable spellings (solt solution)	"water" alone (not enough: the salt is the point); "a week"; "the shade" (the second step).
11	Note completion (a process)	**shade**	the shade; shadow; out of the sun; recognisable spellings	"sun" (the opposite: dried in the sun they crack); "two months" (already in the note).
12	Subject vocabulary explained in context	**B**: how hard you can pull a material before it breaks		A (weight is the comparison, not the measure); C and D (not said).
13	Specific detail (a number)	**11**	eleven	2022 (the year); 2 (months of drying, or tonnes); a third (the saving).
14	Inference joining two parts of the talk	**Two reasons: (1) the poles are hollow, so a bolt through the wall cracks it (the joint is the weak point); (2) the poles are not all the same size, so every joint has to be measured by hand.**	Either reason in other words: "a hollow tube cracks when you bolt it"; "the poles are different sizes, so the joints cannot all be the same"; "the pole is strong but the joint is weak".	One reason only: 0 (the question asks for two and joins the strength paragraph with the drawbacks paragraph). "Because bamboo is a grass" or "because it rots" (true, but not about joints).
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**B**: he thinks they criticise bamboo but are happy to be seen with his building		A is the opposite of his view; C and D are not said. He never says the architects are wrong: the student must hear the irony in "the same architects are quite happy to be photographed in front of our hall".
16	Main idea or speaker's purpose	**B**: to explain how bamboo is used in buildings and make students think about it		A goes too far (he says "I'm not going to tell you what it should be made of"); C is one part of the talk; D exaggerates one sentence. The ending ("I'd like you to ask the question") carries the purpose.

What is in the Part B script (for the English team): about 480 words in 35 sentences (about 14 words a sentence on average); about 21% of the running words are outside the 2000 most common English words (about 29% of the distinct words; `wordfreq` lists, names left out). It uses subject vocabulary explained in context (structural engineer, culm, node, tensile strength, mild steel, timber frame). It explains a process (how a culm grows and hardens; how poles are treated) and a cause and effect (why the joints matter; why steel costs carbon); compares a tree with bamboo, bamboo with steel and pine, and a bamboo frame with a steel one; gives numbers and a date; corrects a number ("Actually, let me correct that"); implies opinions without stating them (the architects, the bicycle shelter); and uses discourse markers (on the other hand, first, second, however, as a result, whereas).

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

If the two parts disagree in an unexpected way (for example Part A 5 or 6 with Part B 5 or more), use the interview to decide: the student may have lost easy marks in Part A through nerves or carelessness.

What to look for

- **Part A** checks everyday listening with two voices: questions 1 to 3 the main points, 4 to 6 exact details with distractors (200, 8 lanes, 6:30), and 7 and 8 implied meaning and the speaker's purpose.
- **Part B** is the step up. Questions 9 to 13 need exact detail from fast, connected speech, with distractors (2 years, the sun, 2022); questions 14 to 16 need the student to join ideas across the talk, hear an attitude that is never stated and see the purpose of the whole talk. A student who gets 9 to 13 but not 14 to 16 follows the content of a lesson but not yet its argument.
- **Part A secure, Part B 0 to 2**: everyday English is fine, but lessons taught only by talk will be hard to follow at first. In Year 11 there is less time to adjust than in Year 10: plan visual support, key vocabulary in writing and frequent checks for understanding from the first week.
- Compare with listening in the interview. If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are two parts, A and B. Part B is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy" or "in your own words". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: a web page of holiday workshops (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	10:00	1	10; 10 am; ten o'clock. Do not accept 12:30 (the end) or 9:30 (Photography).
2	Robotics; First aid	2	1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0).
3	First aid	1	The only workshop for ages 15 and over. Do not accept Robotics (14+: he can join) or Photography (full, but he could join the waiting list; the question asks about age).
4	¥25	1	25; 25 yuan (half of ¥50 with a student card). Do not accept 50 (the half-price note missed).
5	Borrow a camera from the centre (for ¥20)	1	borrow one; rent a camera for 20 yuan. Do not accept "buy a camera" or "join another workshop".
6	Friday 20 June	1	20 June; 20th June. Do not accept "Friday" alone or "Monday" (the first workshop).
7	Add your name to the waiting list (and the centre will email you if a place becomes free)	1	join the waiting list; wait for an email. Do not accept "book online" or "call them".

Part B: "Homing" (a short story, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 15; questions 8 to 14)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Retrieval	Her parents are both working through the summer	1	her parents are busy working; they have to work. Do not accept "because she likes pigeons".
9	Vocabulary in context	without wanting to	1	

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
10	Retrieval with evidence	Any two of: the town has only one shop; one bridge; "no wifi worth the name" (no good wifi); she "counted the days" (accept, although it is in the second paragraph: it shows the same thing)	2	1 mark each, maximum 2. Do not accept "she had not wanted to come" alone (that is her feeling, not a detail about the town) or "her parents were working".
11	Inference (character)	He wants her to see for herself: the answer is to wait and watch; or he is a man of few words and does not explain things; or nobody really knows how pigeons find their way, so he cannot answer	1	Any sensible inference linked to the text (he "was not a talker"; he answers "with a look"; he looks "at the sky"). Do not accept "he did not hear her" or "he is angry".
12	Inference (change in a character)	She has become interested in the birds, or absorbed in whether they will come back; the annoyance has gone; nothing in the town matters compared with the sky	1	"she cares now"; "she is waiting for the pigeons"; "she has stopped being bored". Do not accept "she likes the sky" or "the sky is beautiful".
13	Inference from a comparison	He is calm and not worried; he trusts the bird to come back; he has experience, so a late bird is normal to him	1	"he is patient"; "he is sure it will come". Do not accept "he does not care about the bird" (he counts them and names it).
14	Writer's purpose (structure)	It shows that Chen Yu now wants to go again (her attitude has reversed): she asks the time herself, without being told, after "counting the days" at the start; the ending leaves the reader to notice the change rather than stating it	1	"she is keen now"; "it is the opposite of the beginning"; "it shows she has changed her mind"; "it is a surprise ending that makes you think". Do not accept "because the story is finished" or "because he said tomorrow".

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 3 to 5	**C** Developing competence
Part B 6 to 8	**D** Competent, or **E** Fluent (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. There is no text above age level on this paper, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Part B** is a literary text: the meaning is carried by what characters do and do not say, not by statements. A student who answers 8, 9 and 10 (retrieval and vocabulary) but not 11 to 14 reads the words but not yet the story: inference in fiction is what IGCSE English (First Language or Literature) and the longer texts in other subjects demand.
- **Strong readers** give the change in Chen Yu in their own words (12 and 14) and explain the grandfather from his behaviour (11 and 13). Copying a line that is in the right place but does not answer the question is the commonest sign of a band D reader.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy or copied lines. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Part B may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the Reading front sheet.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out, on the Reading front sheet. IGCSE papers are long; a student who is accurate but very slow will need reading practice and, possibly, an access arrangement assessment if there is a specific need.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (narrative): a story that begins "The box had been in the cupboard for as long as anyone could remember." Task B (discursive): an essay for the English teacher on whether every school should make its students do at least one hour of sport every day, with an opinion, reasons, examples and an answer to the other side. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 15 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the story is a list of events, or the essay lists reasons without explaining them and ignores the other side.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Story: a shape (a build-up, a turning point, an ending that means something), a character the reader can picture, detail chosen for effect. Essay: a clear position, reasons developed with examples, the other side stated and answered, a conclusion; written for a teacher.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("very", "good", "many people"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary chosen for effect (verbs of movement and feeling in the story; words of argument such as benefit, pressure, balance in the essay); a range of linking words (however, moreover, although, as a result); some figurative language that works.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb forms, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types used for effect, including complex sentences and some short sentences for impact; tenses controlled (the story stays in the past; the essay handles conditionals: "if schools did this, ..."); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; a range of punctuation (speech marks in the story, commas after openers, apostrophes, colons, question marks) used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 11 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 70 to 130 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 130 to 220 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary; the essay gives reasons but may not answer the other side.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 15 year old usually writes 200 to 300 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with controlled, varied sentences, precise vocabulary chosen for its effect on the reader, and accurate spelling and punctuation. The story has a shape and an ending that means something, rather than stopping; the essay argues, gives evidence and examples, states the other side and answers it. This is roughly the level a First Language English IGCSE course expects in its second year.

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Nowadays, with the development of society") or memorised essay phrases followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- In Year 11 the student will sit IGCSE writing within about 18 months, in almost every subject. If writing is two bands below reading or listening, name it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: it is the first thing the support plan must address.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide for Years 11 and 12** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y11_Y12`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y11_Y12`). The sentence reading rules are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, and the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. All are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 11 starts at **Level 9 (sentence 25)**, the top start level. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring in the guide. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating, which you record on the Reading front sheet. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block in the Interviewer guide, including **subject choices and why**, **university plans**, **independent study and workload**, what the student knows about IGCSE, and the **Year 11 only** question: whether the student understands that they are joining courses a year in, and what they will do to catch up. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2, the same for every candidate.
- **Speaking band:** give it using the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, and record it on the Interview sheet. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 25 minutes. There are three sections. In Sections A and B, you may not use a calculator. When you get to Section C, on page 17, I will give you a calculator. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can, and look at every page."

The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words and phrases mean (simplify fully, surd form, "in the form $(x + a)^2 + b$", turning point, the nth term); the example at the start of Section B shows what "Write an equation, then solve it" means. They are there so that an English phrase does not hide maths the student can do.

Section	Questions	Marks	Calculator	What it measures
A Fluency	1 to 6	10	No	Algebra and number at the end of the first IGCSE Extended year, with no context: fractional indices, surds, completing the square, factorising with $a \neq 1$, the nth term of a quadratic sequence, simultaneous equations with one quadratic. Demanding on purpose: these students usually find routine algebra easy.
B Word questions	7 to 10	8	No	Maths given only in sentences, with no diagram: the student must read, decide what to do and, usually, form an equation. Inverse proportion, a quadratic from consecutive numbers, probability without replacement, and a speed problem that gives a linear equation.
C Applied problems	11 to 16	12	Scientific	Multi-step problems in real contexts with a graph, a diagram or a table: a cumulative frequency graph, a volume scale factor, circle theorems with a reason, trigonometry, the quadratic formula in a context, and compound against simple interest. Questions 13 and 16 ask the student to give a reason or show a decision.

Calculator. Section C and science only. Before question 14, check that the calculator shows D or DEG (degrees). Many students from Chinese schools rarely use a calculator in maths lessons, so note how fluently they use one

(powers, sin, the quadratic formula) in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: IGCSE calculator papers need it.

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise: in questions 8 and 10 (which ask for an equation) a correct answer with no equation scores 1, in question 13(b) an angle with no reason scores 0, and in question 16 a tick with no figures scores 0. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English (a reason written in Chinese scores 0, but the figures beside it still count).

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 9 (初三)**, so **algebra, quadratics and geometry are usually strengths**: by the zhongkao most have done factorising, surds, quadratic equations by factorising, completing the square and the formula (一元二次方程), quadratic functions and their vertex (二次函数), inverse proportion (反比例函数), similarity (相似), acute-angle trigonometry (锐角三角函数), circle theorems (圆周角, 圆内接四边形) and probability with tree diagrams (概率). Some content on this paper is senior high school (高一) or not in the Chinese course at all, so it **may not have been taught** even to a strong student: fractional indices (高一), the nth term of a quadratic sequence (sequences are 高二), cumulative frequency, volume scale factors of similar solids, and calculator trigonometry with non-special angles. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught: a strong Grade 9 student usually learns these quickly. A student from a school that teaches IGCSE should have met all of it.

Section A: Fluency (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Fractional indices with an algebraic base	$8x^6$	B1. An answer of $12x^6$ ($16 \times 3/4$) or $8x^{11}$ (the index added) scores 0: note which.	Fractional indices are 高一: may not have been taught. A student who sees $16 = 2^4$ may still reason it out.
2	Surds: expanding a bracket	$11 - 6\sqrt{2}$ ($a = 11$, $b = -6$)	B1. An answer of $9 - 2 = 7$ or $11 - 3\sqrt{2}$ means the middle term was lost or halved: the expansion of a square is not secure.	Secure (Grade 8, 二次根式).
3	Completing the square; the turning point	(a) $(x - 4)^2 - 13$ (b) $(4, -13)$	(a) B1. (b) B1, follow through from a correct form in (a) with a wrong b. An answer of $(-4, -13)$ or $(4, 13)$ means the sign is misread from the form: the method is there, the reading of it is not.	配方法 and the vertex form (顶点式) are Grade 9, so the algebra is familiar; the English ("in the form", "turning point") is the barrier (both are in the example box).
4	Factorising with $a \neq 1$	$x = 1/3$ or $x = -2$	M1 for $(3x - 1)(x + 2)$; A1 for both solutions. Correct solutions by the formula score M1 A1 (the question says "by factorising", but the solutions are right); solutions with no working score B1 only. Sign errors such as $x = -1/3$ and 2 are M1 A0.	Secure (Grade 9, 一元二次方程, 十字相乘法 in most textbooks).
5	The nth term of a quadratic sequence	$2n^2 + n + 2$	M1 for the second difference 4 and $2n^2$, or for subtracting $2n^2$ to get 3, 4, 5, 6, 7; A1 for $2n^2 + n + 2$. Accept an equivalent form. A linear answer ($7n - 2$, which fits only the first two terms) scores 0.	Not in the Chinese course as a method: may not have been taught. Pattern questions (找规律) are familiar, so a strong student may find the rule by trial: full marks if it is right.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
6	Simultaneous equations, one linear and one quadratic	$x = 2$, $y = 5$ or $x = -5$, $y = -2$	M1 for substituting to get a correct quadratic, $x^2 + 3x - 10 = 0$ (or $2x^2 + 6x - 20 = 0$); A1 for both pairs. One pair only: M1 A0. Pairs mismatched ($x = 2$ with $y = -2$) score M1 A0.	Substitution and quadratics are Grade 7 and 9; the pairing is less common in Chinese textbooks, but a strong student usually sees what to do.

Section B: Word questions (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
7	Inverse proportion (to a square), from a sentence	1 (unit)	M1 for $y = k/x^2$ with $k = 36$ (or brightness × distance^2 = 36), or for "3 times the distance, so 1/9 of the brightness"; A1 for 1. An answer of 3 (inverse proportion without the square) or 81 (direct proportion to the square) scores 0: the English of "inversely" or "the square" was lost.	Inverse proportion is Grade 9 (反比例函数) and the physics idea is familiar. The sentence is the barrier: read it aloud if it is blank.
8	Forming and solving a quadratic from consecutive even numbers	12 and 14, or −14 and −12	M1 for a correct equation in one unknown, $n(n + 2) = 168$ or $n^2 + 2n - 168 = 0$ (or $2m(2m + 2) = 168$); A1 for both pairs. One pair (12 and 14) with the equation: M1 A0. 12 and 14 with no equation: 1 mark. "Consecutive even numbers" written as n and $n + 1$ gives no integer solution: 0, and it shows the English of "even" was lost.	Secure (Grade 9, 一元二次方程的应用).
9	Probability without replacement, from a sentence	15/28	M1 for 5/8 × 3/7 or 3/8 × 5/7 (= 15/56), or for 1 − (5/8 × 4/7 + 3/8 × 2/7); A1 for 15/28. Accept 30/56, 0.536 (0.54 or better) or 53.6%. 15/56 alone (one order only) is M1 A0. 30/64 (with replacement) scores 0: the student missed "keeps it".	Secure (Grade 9, 概率, 不放回 with a tree diagram); the sentence form is the test.
10	A linear equation from a speed context	6 km	M1 for $d/15 - d/20 = 6/60$ (or an equivalent, for example in minutes: $60d/15 - 60d/20 = 6$, or $4d - 3d = 6$), or for the two times differing by 6 minutes with a correct expression for each; A1 for 6. An answer of 2 km (from "4 − 2") or an equation with 2 minutes instead of 6 (the difference between late and early not seen) scores 0. 6 with no equation: 1 mark.	Secure maths: a classic 行程问题 from Grade 7. If it is wrong, the English is the likely barrier: read it aloud.

Section C: Applied problems (scientific calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
11	Cumulative frequency graph	(a) 42 marks (b) 12 students	(a) B1 for 41 to 44 (read at cumulative frequency 40; the exact reading is 42.2). An answer of 40 (the cumulative frequency itself) or 36 (read at 40 marks) scores 0. (b) B1 for 10 to 14 (80 − 68 = 12). An answer of 68 (the students who scored 60 or less) scores 0: "more than" was lost.	Not taught in Chinese middle school (频数分布 is, cumulative curves are not): may not have been taught. Note NT and look at the reading.
12	Similar solids: volume scale factor	32 000 litres	M1 for the length scale factor 40 (1200 ÷ 30) and 40^3 = 64 000, or for "volume factor = (length factor) cubed"; A1 for 32 000 (accept 32 m^3). Using the length factor (0.5 × 40 = 20 litres) or the area factor (0.5 × 1600 = 800 litres) scores 0: this is the error the question is designed to find. Mixing units (12 ÷ 30 = 0.4) scores 0.	Similarity and area factors are Grade 9 (相似图形的面积比); volume factors of similar solids are not usually taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
13	Circle theorems with a reason	(a) 68° (b) 112°, because opposite angles of a cyclic quadrilateral add up to 180°	(a) B1 (the angle at the centre is twice the angle at the circumference). (b) B1 for 112° **with** a correct reason in English: "opposite angles of a cyclic quadrilateral add up to 180°" or "angles in the same segment / the other side of the circle: 180 − 68". 112° with no reason, or with a wrong reason, scores 0 for (b): the reason is the point. Accept (b) follow through: 180 − (a). An answer of 224° (the reflex angle at the centre) in (b) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9, 圆周角定理, 圆内接四边形). The reason in English is the new demand: "cyclic quadrilateral" or "opposite angles 180" has it.
14	Trigonometry in a right-angled triangle, with a calculator	L = 17.0 m	M1 for sin 32° = 9/L or L = 9/sin 32°; A1 for 17.0 (accept 16.98 to 17.0). 9 × sin 32° = 4.77 (the ratio inverted) scores 0. 9/tan 32° = 14.4 is the horizontal distance: M0. sin 32 = 0.55 means the calculator is in radians: note it. 9/cos 32° = 10.6 confuses the sides: M0.	Grade 9 trigonometry (锐角三角函数) uses special angles without a calculator; sin 32° with a calculator may be new. sin 32° = 9/L unfinished shows the maths: M1, and note the calculator.
15	The quadratic formula in a context	t = 0.74 s and t = 3.26 s	M1 for $5t^2 - 20t + 12 = 0$ (or $20t - 5t^2 = 12$) and the formula or completing the square applied; A1 for 0.74 and 3.26 (accept 0.73 or 0.74, and 3.26 or 3.27). One correct time only: M1 A0. Solving $20t - 5t^2 = 0$ (t = 0 and 4: when the ball is on the ground) scores 0: the 12 m was not used.	Secure (Grade 9, 公式法); the equation is given. Decimal answers with a calculator are the IGCSE habit to look for.
16	Compound and simple interest (Show)	Wang Hao (by about ¥3.63)	M1 for $5000 \times 1.03^5 = 5796.37$ (accept 5796 to 5797), or for 5000 + 5 × 160 = 5800; A1 for both totals and "Wang Hao". Accept the comparison of interest only (796.37 against 800). Li Na's account treated as simple interest (5000 + 5 × 150 = 5750, so Wang Hao) is M0 A0: the conclusion is right for the wrong reason. Compound interest found but no comparison made: M1 A0. A tick with no figures: 0.	Compound growth is Grade 9 (增长率) and simple interest is primary school (利息): usually secure. Two correct totals and a tick is enough.

Sub-scores and total: Fluency (questions 1 to 6) / 10; Word questions (7 to 10) / 8; Applied (11 to 16) / 12; total / 30.

Band guide (provisional, for a paper at the end of the first IGCSE Extended year; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 10 (under 35%): **1** Below expected; 11 to 16 (35 to 54%): **2** Working towards; 17 to 22 (55 to 74%): **3** Expected; 23 to 30 (75% or more): **4** Greater depth, likely top set.

Not tested (not enough time): algebraic fractions, functions (composite and inverse), inequalities, direct proportion, probability with replacement, bearings and upper and lower bounds. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for setting; functions and bounds are also the topics a Year 11 entrant from a Chinese school is least likely to have met.

Reading the three sub-scores

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high (7 or more out of 10), **word questions low** (3 or less out of 8)	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read the word questions aloud in English and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark L). If the student then solves them, record "English barrier in maths" on the grading sheet. This student needs maths vocabulary and practice in reading problems, not a lower tier.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency and word questions high, **applied low** (5 or less out of 12)	The student calculates and sets up equations well but is less practised in multi-step problems in context, reading graphs, choosing a method and giving a reason. Check the NT topics first: questions 11, 12 and 14 include content outside the Chinese course.	Teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Practice with "show that", "give a reason" and graph-reading questions, which fill the IGCSE Extended papers.
All three high (band 4)	A strong mathematician who can read and apply.	Extended tier; likely top set.
Fluency low, word questions and applied higher	Unusual for a student from a Chinese mainstream school; more common from a bilingual or international school where formal algebra comes later.	Check which algebra has been taught. The Extended tier may still fit, with an algebra catch-up plan and a review after one term.
All three low, not explained by NT or L	Gaps in earlier learning, or a possible learning need. Read with the cognitive screen (its guide, Section 9).	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).

What to look for

- **Strong responses** show organised working, correct notation and decisions backed by figures (questions 13 and 16), use the calculator fluently in Section C, and attempt the IGCSE topics (cumulative frequency, volume factors) even when they are new.
- **A correct answer with no reason** (question 13(b)) or **a tick with no figures** (question 16) is common from students used to answer-only questions. It scores 0, but it is a habit that can be taught quickly, not a gap in maths: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **English or maths?** Question 10 is maths that almost every Chinese-school student knows well (a speed problem). If it is wrong or blank but the student solves it once it is read aloud, the barrier is English. The same check works for questions 7 to 9.
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (questions 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 13 and 15), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions (1, 5, 11, 12 and the calculator in 14), write the likely band once taught in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. You may use your calculator. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 11 entrant may not have been taught. A student who has completed Grade 9 in a Chinese school has done biology (Grades 7 and 8), physics (Grades 8 and 9, including electricity and magnetism) and one year of chemistry (Grade 9: atoms, the periodic table, formulae, conservation of mass, acids and bases; the mole is not taught). So most of this paper is familiar content; the new demands are the English of the questions and the working-scientifically question (6). A student from an IGCSE school should have met everything here in Year 10.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Gas exchange and respiration (data in a table)	(a) Carbon dioxide (b) Oxygen is used by the cells in (aerobic) respiration	(a) B1: carbon dioxide; CO_2. Do not accept oxygen or nitrogen. (b) B1: oxygen is used (taken in by the blood, absorbed in the lungs) for respiration, or to release energy in the cells. "Because we breathe it in" or "because the body needs it" alone is not enough: the answer must say what the oxygen is used for.	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 呼吸作用 and 呼吸系统).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
2	Relative formula mass; conservation of mass	(a) 100 (b) 44 g	(a) B1: 40 + 12 + 48. An answer of 68 (one oxygen) or 52 (the oxygen left out) scores 0. (b) B1: 100 – 56 = 44. Accept 44 from the formula mass of CO_2 (12 + 32) with no subtraction: the reasoning is sound. An answer of 56 or 100 scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9 chemistry, 相对分子质量 and 质量守恒定律). The mole is not needed.
3	Specific heat capacity	42 000 J	B1 for 0.5 × 4200 × 20 = 42 000. Accept 42 kJ. An answer of 84 000 (ΔT taken as 40) or 21 000 scores 0.	Secure (Grade 9 physics, 比热容, $Q = cm\Delta t$); the equation is also printed.
4	Hooke's law from a table	10 cm	B1. Accept 10.0. An answer of 7.5 (the table copied) or 2.5 (the extension per newton) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 弹簧测力计: extension proportional to load), although the name "Hooke's law" may be new.
5	Moments (the principle of the lever)	300 N	B1 for 400 × 1.5 ÷ 2 = 300. An answer of 533 (400 × 2 ÷ 1.5) scores 0: the distances were swapped.	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 杠杆平衡条件).
6	Osmosis investigation: pattern, variables, improving a method	(a) The higher the sugar concentration, the smaller the gain in mass, then the greater the loss (or: the mass change goes from a gain to a loss as the concentration rises) (b) One control variable (c) One sensible change to the method	(a) B1: must link both variables; "as the concentration increases, the change in mass decreases (becomes more negative)" is fine. "The potato loses mass" alone is 0. (b) B1: the size, mass or shape of the potato pieces; the time in the solution; the temperature; the volume of solution; the same potato. Do not accept "the concentration" (the independent variable) or "the mass change" (the dependent variable). (c) B1: test more concentrations between 5% and 10% (smaller steps, for example 6%, 7%, 8%, 9%); or plot a graph of mass change against concentration and read where the line crosses zero. "Repeat the experiment" alone is not enough: it improves reliability, not the resolution the question asks for.	Osmosis as a word is IGCSE; the idea (植物细胞的吸水和失水) is Grade 7 biology. Designing and evaluating a method is less familiar in Chinese schools: score what the student writes.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Not tested in the core paper (not enough time): cells and enzymes, transport in plants, atomic structure and bonding, the periodic table, acids and salts, motion graphs, density and pressure, waves and light. The optional sciences cover them for the sciences the student chooses.

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (question 6) is the best guide to IGCSE science readiness: a student who describes a pattern with both variables, names a control variable and suggests a real change of method (smaller steps, a graph) is ready for practical work in English. Compare with the working-scientifically questions in the optional sciences.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (relative formula mass, specific heat capacity, extension, pivot, concentration, variable) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **Strong responses** use units (J, N, g), show the calculation in one line and give precise answers in question 6 (for example "test 6%, 7%, 8% and 9%").

6. Readiness for joining the second year of IGCSE

This section is guidance for the school to confirm, against its own admissions policy, the IGCSE syllabuses it offers (for example Cambridge IGCSE or Pearson Edexcel International GCSE), the entry requirements of its own sixth form, and the support it can provide. It is not a set of fixed rules. Record the results on the grading sheet (Section 7) first, then read the results together.

The question is different from Year 10. A Year 11 entrant joins courses that are already a year in, with the exams about 18 months away. For every subject, the first year's syllabus has to be caught up at the same time as the second year is taught, in English. So readiness means three things: English good enough to learn from lessons and texts **now**, not after a year's adjustment; subject knowledge close enough to the first-year syllabus that the catch-up is a list of topics, not a whole course; and the study habits and motivation to do the catching up. When these are not all in place, a **Year 10 start** is often the kinder and more successful route, and the family should hear this early rather than late.

English is the gateway. Every IGCSE subject except other languages is taught and examined in English. Look at the overall English band, and most closely at **reading and writing**. As a planning assumption, a student rarely moves up more than about one band a year in academic reading and writing, even with good support: a student at band C in Year 11 will probably sit the exams at C or D.

English band	What it usually means for joining Year 11	English course that may fit best
A New to English	Cannot yet follow subject lessons in English. Direct entry to the second year of IGCSE is not advisable (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).	A preparatory or foundation route, or a Year 10 start after intensive English, if the school has one.
B Early acquisition	Can follow simple, supported lessons, but IGCSE texts and exam questions will be very hard, and there is no time to adjust.	Usually a **Year 10 start** with an English as a Second Language course and a reduced subject load, if the school's policy allows; Year 11 only in exceptional cases (for example very strong maths and sciences, with an agreed plan).
C Developing competence	Can follow most lessons with support; subject vocabulary and extended writing will slow progress. Maths and the sciences are usually more accessible than essay-based subjects.	**English as a Second Language**; fewer essay-based subjects; consider a Year 10 start if the maths and science results are also band 2 or below.
D Competent	Usually ready to join IGCSE courses taught in English, with support for academic writing.	English as a Second Language at the higher level, or First Language English if reading is band E **and** writing is a strong D or E (see below). Check with the English department.
E Fluent	Ready for IGCSE study in English.	**First Language English** (and English Literature, if offered, where a year's set texts can be caught up).

What English band does a student realistically need? As a working guide for the school to test: **band D or above in reading and writing**, with listening and speaking at D or above, to join the second year of IGCSE with little extra support; **band C** with an English as a Second Language course, subject-language support and a limited subject load; **band B or below** usually means a Year 10 start. Review these thresholds once the first Year 11 entrants have sat their IGCSEs.

What the English results add. The listening can tell a competent student (D) from a fluent one (E); the reading paper has no text above age level, so it can show a competent reader but cannot on its own confirm a fluent one. Use the hardest parts as the evidence:

- **Listening Part B** is the best guide to following lessons taught by talk. Part B 6 or more: the student can follow a lesson-style explanation with subject vocabulary. Part B 0 to 2 with Part A secure: everyday listening is fine, but lessons will need visual support and key vocabulary in writing at first, and there is less time for this in Year 11.
- **Reading Part B** ("Homing") is the age-level text and the hardest reading on this paper. Part B 7 or 8, with writing at E or a strong D: close to the reading of a fluent speaker. Part B 6 or more otherwise: a competent reader of age-level texts, who will need support with the longest IGCSE texts. When First Language English is being considered,

confirm it with the English department (for example with a further reading task), because this paper has no text above age level.

English as a Second Language or First Language English? First Language English assumes the reading and writing of a fluent speaker and, in Year 11, a year's coursework or practice already done. It is usually the better fit only when reading is band E (Part B 7 or 8, with the sentence reading screen also pointing to E) and writing is band E or a strong D. For most students at band C or D, an English as a Second Language course is the better fit, and a good grade is more achievable. Check what the school's sixth form and likely universities ask for, because some ask for a particular course or grade; tell the family early.

Maths: Extended or Core tier, and what support. Read the total band with the three sub-scores (Section 4), allowing for NT. A Year 11 entrant from a Chinese school has usually been taught almost all of the maths on this paper, so NT explains fewer marks than in Year 10; the gaps are the IGCSE-only topics (fractional indices, functions, sequences, cumulative frequency, volume factors, bounds) and the calculator.

Maths result	What it suggests (for the school to confirm)
Band 4 (23 or more)	**Extended tier**, likely top set. Consider additional or further maths if the school offers it and the English allows.
Band 3 (17 to 22)	**Extended tier.** NT marks on the IGCSE-only topics are expected and are usually caught up in the first half term with a topic list.
Fluency 7 or more, word questions 3 or less (any band)	**Extended tier with support for the English of maths**: maths vocabulary, reading word problems, writing reasons in English. The gap is English, not maths: do not place in Core for this reason alone.
Fluency and word questions secure, applied 5 or less	**Extended tier**, with teaching in problem solving, graph reading and giving reasons ("show that", "explain"). Review after one term.
Band 2 (11 to 16), mostly NT and L	**Extended tier is still possible**: judge the band once taught, and review after six weeks.
Band 2 with errors on taught topics (questions 2, 3, 4, 6, 7 to 10, 13, 15)	**Core tier**, with a learning plan for the gaps; or a Year 10 start if the English is also band C or below. Move to Extended only if a review after one term shows the gaps have closed.
Band 1 not explained by NT or English	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9; the cognitive screen guide, Section 9). If an offer follows, maths support and the Core tier, and usually a Year 10 start. A band 1 that NT or L does explain is treated as band 2.

Science route: separate sciences, combined, or fewer subjects. Read the core science band with the optional sciences the student took (`Y11_Optional_Sciences_Mark_Scheme_v3.1`: band 1 to 4 for each science, with its own NT notes) and with English.

Result	What it suggests (for the school to confirm)
Core science 3 or 4; each chosen science band 3 or 4; English D or E	**Separate sciences** (the sciences chosen), with a first-year topic list to catch up for each.
Core science 3 or 4; chosen sciences band 2 or 3 with NT explaining the gaps; English C or D	**Separate sciences for the strongest one or two**, or a **combined or co-ordinated science** course, with a catch-up plan; review after one term.
Chosen science band 2 with errors on taught topics	That science is not advisable in Year 11 unless the school can provide a full first-year catch-up; **fewer science subjects**, or a Year 10 start.
English B or C with any science result	**Fewer subjects** and a combined course where possible: the vocabulary load of three separate sciences in a second language, with a year to catch up, is the commonest cause of failure.
A science the student did not take	Not available to the student in Year 11 without a full first-year course; say so to the family, and ask about it in the interview if the choice is still open.

Subjects to catch up. For every subject the student will take, name on the grading sheet the first-year content to catch up (the NT topics in maths and the sciences; the set texts in English Literature; the first year of any humanities

course); the departments turn the list into a plan before the student starts. If the list for a subject is most of a year's syllabus, that subject should not be taken in Year 11.

The cognitive ability screen (`shared/Cognitive_Ability_Screen_Guide`) helps to plan support, never to select. Read its profile beside the paper results: non-verbal and quantitative both 9 or more with verbal low usually means strong reasoning with English as the gap (a good sign for catching up); processing speed well below the other parts suggests considering extra time and checking reading fluency; a strong profile with weak paper results points to gaps in prior learning or motivation rather than ability; all three parts 4 or less means discussing further assessment before a decision (the guide, Section 9). The screen is not standardised and is not a diagnosis.

When a Year 10 start would be wiser. Recommend a Year 10 start (or a preparatory route, if the school has one) when: English is band B or below; or English is band C and maths or science is band 2 or below on taught content; or the catch-up list for two or more subjects is most of a year's syllabus; or the interview shows that the student does not understand that they are joining a course a year in, or that the plan is the family's rather than the student's. Say to the family that a Year 10 start is a route to better IGCSE grades, not a judgement on the student. Students who join Year 11 from a school that already teaches IGCSE are the exception: for them, check which syllabus and which topics have been covered.

Reading the results together (examples of common profiles)

Profile	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
English D or E; maths 3 or 4; core science 3 or 4; chosen sciences 3 or 4	Ready to join the second year.	Full subject load; English course by the table above; Extended maths; separate sciences; a short catch-up list per subject.
English E, with listening Part B high and reading Part B 7 or 8; writing E or a strong D	Listens like a fluent speaker and reads close to it.	First Language English (and Literature, if offered and the set texts can be caught up), if the English department agrees.
English C; maths fluency high, word questions well below it; sciences 3 or 4	Strong maths and science; English is the barrier.	Ready with support: English as a Second Language with subject-language support; Extended maths with vocabulary support; separate sciences for the strongest two, or combined; no more than one essay-based subject. Discuss a Year 10 start if the student also wants essay-based subjects.
English C; maths 2 or below on taught topics; sciences 2 or below	The gaps are too wide to close while learning the second year in a second language.	**Start in Year 10**, with English as a Second Language and a learning plan; or a preparatory route.
English B, any maths and science	The English gap is too wide for the second year of IGCSE.	Start in Year 10 with an English as a Second Language course and a reduced subject load, if the school's policy allows; otherwise a preparatory route or a later start.
English D or E; maths band 1 on taught topics	Not an English issue.	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9; the screen guide). If an offer follows, maths support, the Core tier and usually a Year 10 start.
Cognitive screen: non-verbal and quantitative high, verbal low; paper results band C in English	Strong reasoning; English is the gap.	A good candidate for catching up: ready with support, with English as a Second Language and a review after one term.
Strong results, but the interview shows the student does not understand that they are joining a course a year in, or the plan is the family's, not the student's	Readiness is not only academic.	Talk with the family and student about the catch-up load before an offer (Interview sheet, suitability strands). A serious mismatch, or any strand rated 1, goes to the head of section before any offer.

Use the Year 11 interview questions (subject choices and why, what the student knows about IGCSE, and joining a course a year in) to judge whether the student's plans are realistic and their own. Record the readiness judgement on

the grading sheet (the readiness for joining Year 11 boxes and the assessor's comment) and on the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

7. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y11_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too whether Part B of the listening was given, the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen (A or B), any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Mark the cognitive ability screen** from its guide and record the four raw scores (Non-verbal / 12, Quantitative / 12, Verbal / 12, Processing speed / 60) and a one-line profile note on the grading sheet. The screen has no band.
4. **Mark the optional sciences** from their mark scheme and record each science the student took (/ 15, band, NT, L) on the grading sheet; tick "not taken" for the others. If they were given on a second visit, record the date.
5. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
6. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
7. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. Write "Year 11, v3.1" beside the scores on it: the listening is out of 16, the reading paper is out of 16 (Parts A and B), the maths has three sub-scores, and the cognitive screen and the optional sciences have their own lines. The overall English band is the band most skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands lower.
8. **File the marked student paper, the screen booklet and the optional sciences booklet with them** (or shred them under the school's policy).

Year 11 only: readiness for joining the second year. Read the results together with Section 6, then tick on the grading sheet the English course (English as a Second Language, First Language or to decide), the maths tier (Extended, Core or to decide), the science route (separate sciences, combined, fewer subjects or to decide), the readiness (Ready, Ready with support, Start in Year 10 or Not yet) and the support needed, list the subjects and topics to catch up, and give your reasons in the assessor's comment.